

GEORGE, DELLUMS, MILLER WIN BIG IN EAST BAY

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Oakland Community School Graduation

"I WANT TO HELP MY PEOPLE BE FREE"



BPINS photo

The proud and beautiful 1976 Oakland Community School graduates: (left to right) THERESA WILLIAMS, VALERIE WILSON, BARBARA BAKER, JEANINE WILLIAMS, CLEVELAND WILLIAMS, STEFAN GIBSON, EUGENE BURKS, and ALPHONSO LITTLE.

(Oakland, Calif.) - "We can do anything because anything is possible. . . We can save the world. . . We can bring harmony. . . We can make life begin again, you and me."

These words from the song *We Can Do Anything*, sung by the eight truly "Black and beautiful" 1976 graduates of the Oakland Community School (OCS) at the June 10 graduating ceremonies, appropriately captured the uplifting spirit of pride and joy that filled the OCS last Thursday evening.

An overflow crowd gathered in the auditorium of the Oakland Community Learning Center to witness the memorable program (the third graduation for the School), which alternately had the audience laughing in stitches and openly and shamelessly shedding tears of happiness and togetherness. The center of attention was quite naturally the graduates — Valerie Wilson, Eugene Burks, Theresa Williams, Jeanine Williams, Barbara Baker, Stefan Gibson, Alfonso Little and Cleveland Williams. Clearly aware that this was their last activity as OCS students, the young graduates took the opportunity to give their heart-felt expression on what the OCS had meant to them. In the process, they created a night that will live in their memories and those of the audience for years to come.

Strikingly dressed in white, the graduates proceeded into the auditorium beaming with smiles of expectation. After they had taken their seats on stage, they began the program with a recitation entitled "Our School" in

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